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## Alexander Dao

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### Education

**University of California, Santa Cruz**  
**Linguistics Major, Computer Science Minor**

Santa Cruz, CA  
Winter 2027

Thesis: The Visual Word Form Area, Autism, and Childhood Hyperlexia

Relevant Coursework: CSE 13S (C Programming), CSE 40 (Machine Learning), CSE 150 (Advanced Networking)

### Experience

**The American Prospect**  
**Editorial Intern**

Santa Cruz  
January 2026 – Present

- Responsible for research, fact-checking, social media, data entry, and library services for the print magazine and the daily website.
- Expectations include editorial contributions, writing briefs and articles as assigned, generating story ideas, and pursuing individual projects with staff guidance.

**Paystand**  
**Content Analytics Intern**

Santa Cruz  
June 2024 – January 2025

- Developed essential data entry and analytics skills
- Tracked metrics for C-suite to improve engagement with community

### Leadership & Activities

**Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers**  
**Member**

Santa Cruz  
November 2025 - Present

- Society of engineers from all Hispanic backgrounds, affiliated with clubs such as the National Society of Black Engineers (NSBE) and MESA. There is no requirement to be of Hispanic background; was invited by several friends including ranking officers and the current club president.

**Math, Engineering & Science Achievement Program (MESA)**  
**Member**

Santa Cruz  
February 2025 - Present

- Joint peer and staff-led mathematics, engineering, and sciences club @ UC Santa Cruz. Supports achievement for under-represented first-generation college students.

### Skills & Interests

**Technical:** C, Python (Statistical Analysis, ML, CCNA-level Networking), HTML + CSS (self-hosted website)

**Language:** English (Native), Vietnamese (Heritage), Japanese (JLPT N2-level fluency)

**Laboratory:** Neurolinguistics w/ Prof. Dustin A. Chacon, Advanced Networking w/ Prof. Christina Parsa

**Interests:** Sketching, Cycling, Sailing